

Primary Source Annotation 1: Revolutionary Claims

Due: Friday, September 4 at 11:59 PM

Value: 30 points

Format: 600-word primary-source annotation

Purpose

Analyze how revolutionary writers defined universal rights while setting explicit or implicit boundaries around citizenship.

Your task

- Choose one: French Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen (1789), Olympe de Gouges' Declaration of the Rights of Woman (1791), the Haitian Declaration of Independence (1804), or Simon Bolivar's Jamaica Letter (1815).
- Identify creator, immediate audience, political crisis, and the action the source sought to produce.
- Analyze two specific words, categories, or contrasts that define who belongs and who does not.
- Make one claim about the source's revolutionary vision and test it against one silence, contradiction, or excluded group.

Required sources or materials

- HIST 115 Digital Sourcebook, Unit 1
- Course timeline of Atlantic revolutions

Submit

- 600-word annotation PDF.
- Chicago-style note and bibliography entry for the selected source.

Important note

Use the sourcebook transcription and page image together when available. Do not modernize wording inside quotations.

Grading criteria

Criterion	Pts	Full-credit evidence
Context	7	Accurately situates creator, audience, place, and historical moment.
Close reading	9	Analyzes two specific features of the source with careful evidence.
Interpretation	8	Makes a defensible claim and distinguishes inference from fact.
Limits and citation	6	Names silences or limits and supplies a complete Chicago citation.

Submission standards

Upload a readable PDF unless the handout specifies another format. Include your name, course code, and assignment title. Cite borrowed ideas and retain the editable source file. The learning portal timestamp is the official submission time.